

Signed Rational Numbers: Subtraction & Sign Errors

Directions:

- Show your work in the space under each problem.
- Watch the signs! Rewrite each subtraction as adding the opposite before you compute.
- Two problems show another student's work that contains a mistake — find it and fix it.

1. Evaluate: $-5 - 8$

Answer: _____

2. Evaluate: $-7 - (-12)$

Answer: _____

3. Evaluate: $-(-8) - 15$

Answer: _____

4. Jorge computes $-4 - (-6)$ and writes

$$-4 - (-6) = -10.$$

(a) What error did Jorge make? Answer in one sentence.

(b) Find the correct value of $-4 - (-6)$.

Answer: _____

5. Write $<$ or $>$ in the blank to make a true statement:

$$-3 - 5 \quad \underline{\hspace{1cm}} \quad -3 - (-5)$$

6. Evaluate: $3 - (2 - 9)$

Answer: _____

7. Maya computes $-\frac{1}{2} - \frac{3}{4}$ and writes

$$-\frac{1}{2} - \frac{3}{4} = \frac{1}{4}.$$

(a) Explain Maya's error in one sentence.

(b) Find the correct value of $-\frac{1}{2} - \frac{3}{4}$.

Answer: _____

8. **Challenge.** Evaluate: $-\frac{3}{4} - (-\frac{5}{6}) + (-\frac{1}{3})$

Answer: _____